

Baker's yeast beta-glucan supplement reduces upper respiratory symptoms and improves mood state in stressed women.

OBJECTIVE: Several studies have shown a baker's yeast beta-1,3/1,6-d-glucan, extracted from *Saccharomyces cerevisiae*, is effective in reducing the incidence of cold and flu symptoms. This study evaluated the effect of a specific beta-glucan supplement (Wellmune) on upper respiratory tract symptoms and psychological well-being in women with moderate levels of psychological stress. **METHODS:** Healthy women (38 ± 12 years old) prescreened for moderate levels of psychological stress, self-administered a placebo ($n = 38$) or 250 mg of Wellmune ($n = 39$) daily for 12 weeks. We used the Profile of Mood States (POMS) psychological survey to assess changes in mental/physical energy levels (vigor) and overall well-being (global mood state). A quantitative health perception log was used to track upper respiratory symptoms. **RESULTS:** Subjects in the Wellmune group reported fewer upper respiratory symptoms compared to placebo (10% vs 29%), better overall well-being (global mood state: 99 ± 19 vs 108 ± 23 , $p < 0.05$), and superior mental/physical energy levels (vigor: 19.9 ± 4.7 vs 15.8 ± 6.3 , $p < 0.05$). **CONCLUSIONS:** These data show that daily dietary supplementation with Wellmune reduces upper respiratory symptoms and improves mood state in stressed subjects, and thus it may be a useful approach for maintaining immune protection against daily stressors.